

Determining the Underlying Mechanisms of Anomalous Perturbations

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1. Introduction

Psychokinesis stems from the latin words *psyche*, meaning mind, and *kinesis*, meaning movement and it refers to the alleged ability to influence matter through mental processes alone. It is generally classified in two forms: micro PK and macro PK, referring to the scale at which the phenomena occurs. It was first coined by Joseph B. Rhine during his experiments with the rolling of dice, when statistically significant results were found when an individual attempted to influence the outcome (Rhine 1943).

A more recent term for psychokinesis (PK) is known as anomalous perturbation, signifying a change in the environment with unknown origins. Like most psi phenomena, anomalous perturbation (AP) is highly controversial in the world of academia and research. Furthermore, even prominent psi researchers disagree on whether AP is a legitimate phenomena or is actually a form of general extra-sensory perception (also known as anomalous cognition). Despite skepticism from mainstream research institutions, numerous high quality anecdotal reports and peer reviewed studies have shown statistically significant results on the reality of the phenomena. AP has been tested and displayed in a multitude of ways including the tossing of dice (Ferrari 1991), the growth rates of plant matter, influence on true random event generators (Nelson 1991), the bending of spoons, energy healing modalities (Astin 2000)(Schlitz 2012) and the infamous double-slit experiment (Radin 2012)(Radin 2025). Though statistically significant results have been found in many cases, the mechanisms of AP are mostly unknown. This warrants further scientific inquiry.

The phenomena has been seen to exhibit similar testing difficulties to that of GESP studies, including

reproducibility, the decline effect and both the belief and comfort factors of the participant. This paper aims to explore the theoretical considerations of AP as well as propose methods for testing this phenomenon as to contribute to the ongoing discourse in parapsychology with the goal of determining the mechanisms of anomalous perturbation.

2. Theoretical Considerations

2.1 Theoretical Frameworks

2.1.1 DAT

Decision Augmentation Theory (DAT), proposed by physicist Ed May posits that all psi phenomena operate in a retro-causal manner, meaning that individuals can gain information about the future by “sending it back in time” at the moment of feedback. May supports this theory by demonstrating the statistical deviance of force-based psi models in anomalous cognition (May 1995). He argues that the measurements of AP themselves are biased by anomalous cognition.

This theory is favored by many parapsychologists and more recent studies (Bem 2011) show statistically significant results in 8 of 9 experiments when testing for different time reversal effects and non-PK effects (May 2021). However, DAT does not adequately explain cases of macro PK, RSPK or energy healing and fails to take into account instances in which feedback is not given to the individual, nor does it propose the physical mechanism in which this retro-cognition occurs.

2.1.2 FST

First Sight Theory (FST) was developed by James Carpenter, a notable psychologist, in his book

First sight: ESP and parapsychology in everyday life. FST implies that AC and AP are innate abilities of the human experience. According to Carpenter, these informational signals are normally filtered out by natural brain processes and thus limit psi abilities (Carpenter 2004).

The First Sight model emphasizes the role of psi within the unconscious focusing away or towards extrasensory content. Carpenter identifies three areas of experience to support this: subliminal sensory perception, memory and acts of creativity, implying that psi is a natural process rather than some form of knowledge gain or action. He argues that the human brain relies on extremely subtle environmental changes to discern this information. Carpenter also postulates that there may be some non-local aspect of human consciousness, which could be an explanation for AP.

Carpenter further develops this theory by revisiting it in the Journal of Parapsychology (Carpenter 2012) and also suggests concepts for further tests of psi, including measuring psi phenomena during normal activity as opposed to experimental settings, distinguishing between scoring directions and amplitudes as well as working with other psychologists to develop better unconscious brain sensing methods.

2.1.3 Quantum Consciousness

Quantum mechanics and consciousness have been intertwined since the first double slit experiment. In this famous laboratory test, scientists discovered that the observation of photons caused them to shift from a probabilistic wave-like form to a deterministic particle-like form, sparking debate of the role of consciousness in the collapse of the quantum wavefunction. Over 100 years later, discourse over the interpretation of the observer effect continues to this day.

In reference to psi, quantum mechanical phenomena appear to operate in a similar manner. Entanglement for example, demonstrates that objects can influence one another over great distances. However, it is important to note that, according to our current

understanding of scientific principles, no information can be transmitted through this phenomenon. Another effect, quantum tunneling, displays properties of passing through physical barriers, similar to that of anomalous cognition through solid objects. Though it is important to note that this occurs in very small scales and specific conditions.

A theory attempting to bridge physics and consciousness known as Orchestrated Objective Reduction (ORCH-OR), proposed by anesthesiologist Stuart Hameroff and physicist Roger Penrose, claims that microtubules located within neurons have the ability to operate as a quantum oscillator (Hameroff 2007). This effectively would allow conscious quantum effects to take place in the human brain and could allow for an explanation to anomalous cognition and anomalous perturbations alike. One of the criticisms of the theory is that quantum effects are extremely difficult to replicate, even in near zero kelvin microscopic environments, much less body temperature environments at a larger scale.

Furthermore, physicists Walter von Lucadou, Hartmann Römer and parapsychologist Harald Walach propose a theoretical framework for psi using the lens of weak quantum theory (Lucadou 2007). This theory expands beyond traditional small scale quantum theory and extends it to larger systems with weaker quantum effects as a result.. By using a correlation matrix method from quantum mechanics, the framework aims to take all potentially positive psi factors from experiments into account. Instead of looking at a single correlation, the matrix includes extensive personality and environmental factors to determine psi conductance.

2.1.4 Zero-Point & Subtle Energy

Another viewpoint is that current physics theory is insufficient to describe psi and an entirely new branch or field of physics is required. One such concept was produced by a Stanford physicist William Tiller known as Subtle Energy. Tiller proposes that the four fundamental forces of physics including electromagnetism, gravity, weak nuclear and strong

nuclear, are unable to account for phenomena such as AC or AP, and consequently an entirely new fundamental force is needed (Tiller 1993). This theory proposes that some new, subtle or imaginary, energy interacts with the zero-point of quantum systems. At the zero-point level, or lowest energy level, (mathematically) imaginary particles can still influence the energy and magnetic vector potentials of the system and produce real effects, despite the absence of real particles in the system. While the concept may well describe anomalous phenomena, testing for this imaginary field proves difficult and is not entirely useful for experimentation.

2.1.5 Biophotons

Ultra-weak photon emission from biological matter, biophotons for short, have also been proposed as a mechanism for AP. This essentially is a process that produces ultraviolet light from living systems and has the potential to transmit information, therefore the ability to influence the external environment through non-physical means. Highly statistically significant results have been discovered with this process when individuals attempt to perform energy healing or qi raising methods, suggesting that biophotons are somehow related to AP (William 2013). The mechanisms behind the production of biophotons is still unknown. It should be noted that biophotons have gained interest in non-parapsychology fields as a method for biological communication and non-invasive diagnostic techniques.

2.2 Theoretical Implications

Theories of psi, more specifically psychokinesis, have a wide range of explanations from time travel, quantum oscillators in the brain, subconscious non-local perceptions, additional fields and mysterious biological light. Largely, they fall into two categories: quantum effects and retrocausation. Quantum effects imply that AP is a distinct phenomena and has physical

consequences, while retrocausation suggests that AP does not in fact exist and is merely a form of AC.

Even without acknowledgement of AP, some of the frontier questions and technological goals of physics include that of the ability to time travel, faster than light communication, large scale quantum effects and unified field theories. It's clear that from peer reviewed studies and leading theories in psi, psychokinesis is inherently intertwined with these deep questions and goals of the physics community. Anomalous perturbation serves as a prime test bed for exploring such phenomena, due to the cost effectiveness of AP experiments compared to particle colliders, space stations, gravitational wave observatories and things of the like.

Moreover, it is essential to examine the conditions under which these phenomena may be deemed reliable and reproducible through empirical scientific methods. Given the prevalence of conflict, violence, and hatred in the world, the potential implications of abilities such as time travel or the capacity to influence matter at a distance—both living and non-living—could have profound consequences for humanity. Such capabilities might offer unprecedented opportunities for understanding and addressing the root causes of societal discord, fostering peace, and enhancing the overall well-being of individuals and communities—if used correctly.

3. Encouraging Psychokinetic Phenomena

3.1 Minimization of Noise

Noise in parapsychology experiments is produced externally in the environment and also internally within the participant of the study through mental chatter and analytic overlay. The minimization of external sensory input has been shown to be effective in producing psi as evident in the Ganzfeld procedure. Internal noise proves more difficult to control in an experimental setting. Meditators are often better at reducing mental noise than non-meditators.

Another way to reduce mental noise is through transcranial magnetic stimulation (rTMS). This method

introduces a magnetic field directed at a specific portion of the brain and temporarily induced lesions, minimizing the operations in that area of the brain. Recent studies indicate that inhibiting the left medial middle front lobe (more specifically Brodmann areas 9, 10 and 32) through rTMS is conducive for AP phenomena (Freedman 2024).

3.2 Psychological Factors

Several psychological factors have been correlated to successful displays of psi in the Ganzfeld including belief in psi, extraversion, number of trials in a day, comfort and creativity (Dalton 1997). Some of these factors may well have correlations to AP phenomena in addition to AC, though less research has been done on the personality correlations of AP. In a study of individual's mental influence on the double-slit experiment, it has been found that individuals more experienced in outward attention, such as magicians (not the stage performing kind), performed better than inwardly focused individuals such as meditators to a statistically significant degree (Radin 2025).

3.3 Crisis

In anecdotal cases of RSPK, it's been reported by investigators that in times of crisis by either AP conducive individuals or their loved ones, anomalous perturbations are produced by the individual. This is true in the case of Tina Resch and other poltergeist cases (Williams 2019). Unpleasant stimuli directed towards participants or their loved ones may increase the likelihood of anomalous perturbations.

4. Testing Psychokinesis

4.1 Aims of Testing

The goal of a scientific experiment varies according to the institution and researchers. Generally, it is to test a hypothesis, theory or idea about a phenomena and provide as much useful data as possible.

In order to be accepted by the scientific community, the experiment must be done in a scientifically sound manner, meaning researcher bias and

file-drawer effects must be minimized, and preventative techniques such as blinding must be maximized. This is important for controversial topics such as psi in order to support or contradict current hypotheses and assist in determining mechanisms. The experiment must be easily repeatable so that other laboratories can run the experiment themselves, either finding results that agree or disagree with the original hypothesis and furthermore adding robustness to the field.

4.2 Proposed Tests

4.2.1 Conducive Environment

All of the mentioned tests below should be done in the most conducive environment possible while attempting to produce statistically significant results and useful data, all while adhering to strict scientific methods. For the participants, this means maximizing criteria like psi correlated personality factors, using meditators or magicians as participants, rTMS techniques and even making the experiment fun or game-like to increase comfort factors and reduce decline effects. For the researchers, this means minimizing bias, using at least double blinding techniques, taking as much information in the form of EEG, heart rate, skin conductance, timestamps, geomagnetic effects, etc. as well as making use of the Lucadou correlation matrix.

4.2.2 Faraday Cage

A Faraday cage is a box in which the inside contents are completely sealed off from external electromagnetic sources. Things like radio waves or other signals are unable to penetrate the box. In order to determine if AP is dependent on electromagnetic fields, tests must be done by individuals outside a faraday cage while the target of influence remains inside. The difficulty of this experiment lies in the effect of belief in psi functionality. Many participants believe they must be able to see the object in order to influence it, and current faraday cages are unable to be constructed without windows.

The importance of an experiment of this manner is it would further support one of the two camps of AP phenomena. AC has already been proven to be effective with the use of a faraday cage, and determining whether AP is effective in the same conditions would further

support the idea that AP is just another form of AC, or a separate phenomena altogether.

4.2.3 Pseudo-Crisis

Experimenters cannot morally put participants or their loved ones in crisis, but one can find inspiration in studies of presentiment (Bem 2011). Conducting a pseudo-crisis in the form of negative stimuli for participants or loved ones of the participants may increase the likelihood of AP. This would further explore the role of the subconscious and the involvement of AC in anomalous perturbations.

4.2.4 Physiological & Personality Factors

Studies suggest that different psi phenomena (ESP, mediumship, PK) produce distinct effects in different brain regions (Perez 2012) (Freedman 2024). Does this mean AC and AP are different phenomena? Not necessarily, further research must be done on these brain regions and the specific functioning of the cells within these regions to determine how they might be receiving external information or influencing the environment.

Extensive research has been done on the personality factors associated with anomalous cognition, while less has been done for anomalous perturbation. By designing experiments that aim to determine such factors, the difference or similarity between AC and AP may be more clearly defined.

4.2.5 Material Analysis Oriented Studies

One of the unique factors of anomalous perturbation is that it appears to alter the environment in some unknown way. Most comprehensive studies of AP have explored cases of micro PK in REG or double-slit devices and energy healing. While this has shown statistically significant results, a broader test range may supply more information and tell researchers more about the mechanisms of the phenomena. Much like Carpenter's recommendation to look at the amplitudes of target successes (Carpenter 2012), more specific results can be extracted from experiments.

By using physically larger samples, one can begin to study the effects of macro PK and AP as a whole. There is a plethora of anecdotal macro PK from the bending of spoons to the falling of pictures in RSPK cases, but very little laboratory tests have been

conducted, perhaps due to comfort and belief factors. Testing for macro PK would also add to the debate of retrocausal versus quantum effects as a mechanism for AP in a significant way, making it less likely for retrocausation to be a viable explanation if macro PK can show statistically significant results.

Furthermore, testing for a wider variety of factors may yield more data about the limits and functions of AP. A few examples of studies with this in mind include: trying to alter simple atomic structures, influencing single cells versus groups of cells and the changing of mass, density or temperature in a variety of materials. Finding the limits and strengths of AP is absolutely essential for determining the mechanisms behind it.

5. Conclusion

The exploration of anomalous perturbation, commonly called psychokinesis, and its associated phenomena presents a complex interplay of theoretical frameworks, empirical evidence, and experimental challenges. Decision Augmentation Theory (DAT) and First Sight Theory (FST) offer perspectives on retrocausal mechanisms of psi and AP, yet both theories have limitations in fully accounting for the breadth of psi phenomena. While DAT emphasizes retro-causality and the potential for future information to influence present actions, it struggles to explain macro PK and instances devoid of feedback. Conversely, FST posits that psi abilities are innate and filtered by cognitive processes, yet it does not provide a comprehensive understanding of the non-local aspects of consciousness or mechanisms that may underlie these experiences. The use of quantum mechanics to describe consciousness and psi phenomena as seen in theories like Orchestrated Objective Reduction (ORCH-OR) and weak quantum theory, brings an alternate perspective that may describe the physical aspect of AP phenomena that DAT and FST fail to. However, the act of replicating large scale quantum effects, less in biological systems, remains a challenge. Furthermore, the concepts of subtle energy and biophotons introduce additional layers of complexity and consideration, proposing that entirely new forms of

energy may interact with existing physical laws to facilitate psi phenomena.

The mechanisms behind anomalous perturbation, much like the rest of psi, are entirely unknown. From the theories covered in this paper, it may be likely that psi phenomena operates in both a retrocausal manner (due to the statistical significance found in DAT), but makes use of quantum effects (due to the nature of quantum mechanics and the increasing relevance of it in biological theories), though this still does not account for all psi phenomena. Investigation of these theories through well-designed experiments is crucial for advancing our understanding of AP and its implications. Experimenters must take into consideration environmental and personality factors, scientific methods and the quality and breadth of the data the experiments are to produce.

As we consider the broader implications of these phenomena, particularly in the context of societal challenges, the potential for harnessing abilities like time travel or remote matter influence and healing could offer staggeringly transformative solutions to the problems of today. However, rigorous scientific studies and scrutiny is essential to establish the reliability and reproducibility of these phenomena. Simply put, more funding for anomalous perturbation research must be established. Furthermore, the reality of harnessing such a phenomena must be thoroughly considered through a moral lens before it is to be replicated and used by the general population, otherwise the consequences may be truly catastrophic.

Ultimately, the pursuit of understanding psychokinesis not only adds to the field of parapsychology but also adds to the very current fundamental questions of physics, consciousness, biology and the nature of reality itself. Consequently, continued research in this controversial topic may well bring innovative solutions to humanity's most pressing issues, despite academia's belief of anomalous perturbations and their origins.

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